

1696

THE QING INVADE MONGOLIA

Now firmly in control of the territory of the former empire, China's Qing dynasty launched a series of expansionist campaigns against Mongol tribes beyond the Great Wall. In 1696, the Kangxi Emperor led an 80,000-strong army across the Gobi Desert to attack the Dzungars, the most powerful Mongol confederacy. Victorious at the battle of Jao Modo, the emperor was able to extend Chinese rule over the whole of Outer Mongolia.



▷ Qing warrior on horseback

1695

1697 A peace agreement, the Treaty of Ryswick, ends the Nine Years' War in Europe



1696

SIEGE OF AZOV

Aspiring to make Russia a great power, Tsar Peter the Great sought access to the Black Sea, which was then controlled by the Ottoman Empire. In 1695, he laid siege to the Ottoman fortress of Azov on the Black Sea coast, but the siege failed for lack of naval power. In 1696, he returned with a fleet of galleys and took the fortress. A major southward expansion of Russian influence had begun.

◁ *Capture of Azov*, Robert Ker Porter



1654-1722
THE KANGXI EMPEROR

Ruling China for 61 years from 1661, the Kangxi Emperor unified the country. He reconciled the Han Chinese to Manchu rule by embracing Confucian traditions and promoting prosperity.